For twelve years, nearly, Campbell had been the center of my literary existence. He had nurtured me, protected me, fostered me, and made me what I was, and there is no way in which I can ever be sufficiently grateful to him.

By 1950, however, I had grown beyond him.

In part, it was because he had taken a wrong turning. He had moved into dianetics and from there into a series of other follies, and there was no way in which I could follow him. Furthermore, he could not separate his personal views from the magazine, but strove to incorporate those views into the stories he elicited from the authors, and many authors were only too delighted to comply and to "press Campbell's buttons." I could not do it any more than I could comply with his penchant for human superiority over extraterrestrials in earlier years.

Second, there were new markets opening up, and I wanted to branch out. I did not want to be a one-editor author. Moving into the book field and being associated with Brad and Doubleday was a major step for me, and on April 28, 1950, something else opened up.

On that day, I got a letter from Horace L. Gold. I had met him once or twice before the war, and a story, "None but Lucifer," by him and Sprague de Camp in collaboration was one of the most powerful lead novels in the old Unknown. His solo short story, "Trouble with Water," also in Unknown, was likewise unforgettable.

Now, it seemed, Horace was starting a magazine of his own, and he was writing to ask me for some stories.

I responded politely and suggested an idea for a story I called "Darwinian Poolroom." I was deep in the third attempt of The Stars, like Dust—, which seemed to have been occupying me forever, and I welcomed the thought of a break.

By May 7, I had once again finished a third of the book, in its third version, and the next day I mailed off one copy to Fred and one copy to Brad. Nothing to do but wait again.

Meanwhile, I could do other writing, and though Horace had been less than enthusiastic about my idea, that didn't bother me. If he didn't

want it, someone else might. It was only twenty-five hundred words long and took me only a couple of days to write.